

DRIP TRIP Clients getting IV drip therapy done at the Shiffa Wellness Clinic in Mumbai

₹524
CRORE
Value of the Indian hydration & wellness IV therapy segment in 2023, according to consulting firm Grand View Research

higher than in oral supplements, allowing for immediate absorption. Common ingredients include vitamin C, B-complex, magnesium, calcium and antioxidants (substances that prevent cell damage) like glutathione. Clinics offering these promise a rainbow of benefits—boosted immunity, increased energy, digestive health, improved fertility, better concentration, glowing skin, anti-ageing effects, and support for chronic health issues.

The craze rides the endorsement of global celebrities like the Kardashian sisters, Rihanna and Madonna to Bollywood celebs like Jahnvi Kapoor and Sara Ali Khan, who have been filmed getting IV drips. Influencers such as Apoorva Mukhija, Surbhi Agarwal and Omais Khan, too, have posted reels showing IV drips as part of their beauty prep. Studios in Mumbai and Delhi—like Reviv India or Isya Aesthetics, respectively—offer group packages that include mood lighting, chilled fruit infusions and curated playlists. IV vitamin drip sessions typically range from Rs 1,500 to Rs 25,000 a session. Bridal cocktail packages are more expensive, running into lakhs if they involve a group or other add-ons such as décor, sound system and customised clothing. Despite the cost, demand is high.

The Highs...

What was considered a purely medical procedure to restore nutrient levels and support bodily function is now being put to cosmetic use. "Pre-pandemic, IV therapy was associated with medical treatment or high-performance athletes," says a spokesperson for Nimativ, an IV drip therapy centre in Bengaluru. "Post-pandemic, with a global shift toward detoxification and biohacking, there's a threefold rise in demand." Highlighting how these therapies transcend gender, Additi Zaverie of Shiffa Wellness in Mumbai reveals, "Nearly 45 per cent of our IV drip clients are male." In Bengaluru, 33-year-old Ravi Shekhar Prasad, a marketing consultant, is a regular at an upscale IV drip clinic. "I go every fortnight. It's like liquid energy. I feel more focused, and my gym sessions are more productive," he says. For him, the infusions are part of a performance lifestyle.

Today, an IV drip can be done at home, in a spa, at parties, and even inside a car. "I usually ask a private wellness clinic to send an IV drip for me upon my arrival at the Delhi airport to reduce exhaustion from the flight," says Anmol Batra (name changed), a restaurateur.

Dr Rajat Kandhari, a dermatologist from Delhi, acknowledges that such drips are becoming popular for skin health. "IV vitamin drips can help in ways—such as feeling better energy, cellular regenerative capacities and, to some extent in getting lighter skin colour when they contain glutathione," he says. But he is not sure about the therapy's effectiveness for acne or dark circles as there is no data to support it.

...And the Lows

Much of the claims about these treatments, say experts, are anecdotal and driven by celebrity marketing. "Your body has built-in mechanisms to regulate nutrient absorption. Flooding your system with vitamins it doesn't need often results in 'expensive urine'," says dietitian Vidhi Chawla. Take glutathione, a natural antioxidant commonly used in IV drips. Though marketed for skin-brightening and anti-ageing, it is not approved for beauty use by the US Federal Drug Administration. Administered unsafely, it can cause



"IV THERAPY IS USUALLY SAFE WHEN DONE CORRECTLY. BUT REAL WELLNESS STILL COMES FROM A BALANCED DIET, REGULAR EXERCISE, HYDRATION AND ENOUGH SLEEP"

DR P. VENKATA KRISHNAN
Senior consultant, Artemis Hospital